

Trinity

TH311-35 Theology 1: Prolegomena and Bibliology

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Introductory Paragraph

The Trinity is the topic of this paper. The doctrine of the Trinity is important, and there are many unbiblical doctrines that pervert this essential doctrine. The consequence of perverting this doctrine is a lack of salvation. It is critical in our understanding of God because it is a doctrine of who is God - that Jesus is God.

The Trinity is the most important doctrine. It says that Jesus, the Holy Spirit, and the Father are God. They are three distinct persons, yet all one God. The most important part of this doctrine is the Divinity of Jesus, which will be the focus of this paper. Every single cult is a cult because they deny the Trinity - at least most cults. The Trinity causes people to worship Jesus and justifies justification by faith. Without it, people view Jesus as not God and they worship the wrong God. They are not believing in God. This is the most important doctrine in Christianity.

Jesus is God. If he is not God, all the Catholics and Christians are worshipping the wrong God because they are worshipping Jesus. The first thing I will discuss is justification by faith. We are justified by Jesus' perfect works. We place our faith in Jesus and these perfect works are imputed to us. If Jesus is not God, how can he do perfect works when only a perfect person can do perfect works and only God is perfect? Also, how can Jesus take the sins of the world if he is not God? Essentially, he has to bear the eternal wrath of eternal hell. But only God could overcome hell.

There is a catch though. Jehovah Witnesses believe that Jesus was a vessel through which God atoned for sin. Thus, even if Jesus is not God, God used Jesus and so God atoned for sin even though Jesus is not God. To this claim, I cannot perfectly counter directly, but Romans says if you believe that Jesus is Lord you are saved. If salvation is through faith in Jesus, shouldn't this Jehovah Witness theory say that we are saved in faith in God through Jesus? But it is faith in Jesus. Jesus is the end object of our faith. And of course, we are to believe in God. Thus, Jesus must be God.

There are many defenses for the Trinity. Detractors will say, "The word Trinity never shows up in Scripture." However, it says in Philipians and Revelation to Worship

Jesus. Also, the Great Commission says to baptize in the name of the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. When it says name, it says a single name, not three names. And why would we baptize someone in Jesus' name if Jesus is not God? Also, Jesus says that he claims equality with God in the gospels. And Jesus says he is the Way the Truth and the Life. He doesn't say that he knows the Way, the Truth, and can give Life. He says he is those things. He is God. This is in contrast with Muslim faith, which says that Jesus is a prophet, and not God. Also, back to the idea of justification by faith Muslims, believe that Jesus was not crucified. If Jesus was not crucified, there is no imputation of justification, and we must work to earn salvation. And this is the faith of the Muslims. As you can see, the idea of the Trinity affects the way of salvation. If Jesus is God, we can rest in God. Otherwise, we must work for heaven.

Now I shall look at the resurrection. If Jesus is God, it makes sense that God can resurrect from the dead, because he is omnipotent. However, according to Jehovah Witnesses, they say, God raised him from the dead. This is what it says in Acts. The gospel says that Jesus says I am the resurrection. This is something that my undergraduate Bible teacher taught me. But don't get it confused he was the one who was espousing Jehovah Witness faith, and testing my knowledge. John 5:21 says that the father is the one who can resurrect the dead, and yet he says right after that, the son has the ability to quicken whom he wills. This is a statement of Jesus' divinity. Jesus says I am the resurrection, and I lay my life down for the sheep and I lay it down, and I take it up again. This is clearly saying that Jesus has the ability to raise himself from the dead. This is in contrast to the Jehovah witness doctrine.

Probably one of my favorite verses in the Bible is John 1. It says in the beginning was the word, and the word was with God and the word was God. It is very clear that this word is Jesus Christ because later in John one, it says that the word became flesh and it is very clear that this word is Jesus Christ. One concept I wanna talk about is where was Jesus before he was born. 1 Corinthians 15 says that Jesus is a Life giving spirit. Second Corinthians 3 says Jesus is the Spirit. And John, once says, in the beginning, was the word. What I'm trying to say is Jesus existed from the beginning of time, and even before time began. Jesus is eternal. He existed before Adam and Eve. He says before Abraham I am. When he says I am he is referring to I am who I am. In the phrase, I am who I am is a statement of being of eternality. He was a Spirit before he was man, and is still and always is a Spirit.

One of the concepts that I struggle with is, "Is God the Father separate from the Holy Spirit?" In many places in the New Testament, and even in the Old Testament, it speaks of a spirit, but it does not speak of a Holy Spirit. Holy Spirit is more of a new term. It is a Christian term I think that the Bible usually talks about spirits rather than Holy Spirit, especially in the Old Testament. Therefore, my question is, "is God, the father, who is spirit the same as the Holy Spirit?" I think this is a very hard question to answer. The only answer that I have is when the great commission is given, it says to baptize them in the name of the father, son, and Holy Spirit. This seems to give the distinction between the father and the Holy Spirit.

One of the most peculiar doctrines about the trinity is Mormonism. Mormonism says God The father has a grandfather who has a grand grandfather. Also, it says that we can also become godfather too - of our own planet. What they say is that God the

father used to be a regular human being just like us, but that through sanctification, he became God the father. There's just too many Bible verses that counter this doctrine. It is totally unbiblical. It can only be justified with extra biblical text, such as the book of Doctrines and Covenants by the Mormons. If everyone can become God the father, it is not the Trinity, but a Billion-ty.

But I have a very honest question: "Am I the fourth part of the Trinity?" There are plenty, plenty, plenty of Bible verses, that say that I partake of the divine nature. That I am raised with Christ, and then, if I'm raised with him, I will reign with him and I am a co-heir of Christ. I am the body of Christ - we are his hands and feet. And if someone points to my hand, and says "Dennis," then I will say, "You are pointing at me. The hand is me. I am my hand." So it is only logical to conclude I am Jesus.

The most important part of the Trinity doctrine is that Jesus, who is a human, is God. and the most important part of this doctrine is that the kind human relatable, sympathetic person that we know of the loving Jesus is also the great majestic Almighty, all powerful all knowing super power Yahweh. This changes our conception of God and Jesus. When we think of Jesus, we think of a weak, frail, but kind man. And when we think of God, we think of someone who is super strong, and we above us who we cannot relate to. But the Trinity says that these two persons are one in the same. It has personally been one of the most interesting and confounding doctrines to me. I have a good conception of Jesus as a kind person and I love and can talk to. Even now, it's hard to imagine him as Yahweh the Almighty God.

This goes to the Christian life regarding the Trinity. When we need someone to sympathize with and to talk to we can go to Jesus. When we need someone to destroy

our enemies to judge the nations, we can go to the Father. When we need the gifts of the Holy Spirit, and to speak in tongues and the prophesy, and to do mighty works, we can go to the Holy Spirit. And when we think doctrinally, we can say we are always going to the same one God.

The Trinity is the most important doctrine in Christianity. Defending it is the most important thing. This doctrine distinguishes cults from correct doctrine. The reason why it is so important is because it is salvific. If someone does not believe in the trinity, they are damned to hell. The reason is because they do not believe that Jesus is God. And thus, they believe in the wrong God. And thus, they do not believe in God. There are so many cults that deny the Trinity. But to the one who espouses the Trinity, they find a loving Jesus, who is also Almighty. They find three persons who help the Christian in all aspects of their life.